2.26 Death and the Grieving Family

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I cannot believe he is gone." **Objective** • Crying • Shock	**ACTUAL** **Grieving** related to death of a family member as evidenced by crying and expressions of disbelief.	The family can grieve in a supportive place.	• Give them a private room. • Let them spend time with the person who has died. • Call the deceased by name. • Respect cultural and religious practices.	Family express their feelings openly: **goal met**.
Subjective • "We do not know what to do now." **Objective** • Unsure about the procedures • Keep asking what they should do	**ACTUAL** **Interrupted family processes** related to death of a family member as evidenced by confusion about next steps.	Before leaving, the family can say what happens next.	• Explain how the body is released and how the death certificate is issued. • Give written information and phone numbers. • Call the social worker if needed. • Respect religious requirements about the timing of burial.	Family understand the next steps: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Death was sudden • Little family support	**RISK** **Risk for maladaptive grieving** as evidenced by risk factors: unexpected death and lack of support.	Before leaving, the family name at least two sources of support.	• Find out what support the family has. • Tell them about bereavement support. • Encourage them to call the unit later with any questions.	Family name their sources of support: **goal met**.